



UNIVERSITY OF
SASKATCHEWAN

Student Employment
and Career Centre

Career Assessment Guide



www.usask.ca/secc

Discover
who I am

How this guide works.

The following pages contain a collection of six different career self-assessments. Each one is designed to offer you insight into different aspects of your personality, interests, skills, and values. We have included assessments that are pretty simple to work with but they will take some time and thought on your part. Some may be more interesting and perhaps offer more insight than others, but all are equally important and deserve a look.

Your Career Blueprint

As you work through these assessments, all of your responses are automatically captured on page 14–16 to create your own personal Career Blueprint. This will serve as a summary of all your preferences and ideas. Then, at the very end, we will explore possible next steps including resources for researching occupations, finding a job, and getting advice.

Some quick tips to get you started...

Here are some pointers to help you make the most of this guide:

- **Make a commitment.** Defining and reaching your career goals is not going to happen overnight. Some pieces may fall seamlessly in place, but deciding on where you want to go and then getting there is going to take some time and self-reflection. Altogether, it will take you about 2-3 hours to complete all the exercises in this guide.
- **Trust yourself.** If you feel drained and bored at your job in retail but can spend hours talking to people about history, pay attention. This can be a powerful message about the types of work that will feed your mind and soul.
- **Be honest with yourself.** If you feel pressured to become a doctor but watching Grey's Anatomy makes you queasy, you may have some thinking to do. As you discover your true needs and goals, you may uncover a whole new world of options that you never even dreamed were possible.
- **Save it as a PDF.** As your future unfolds, there will be a lot of choices and options to explore. The ideas you capture in this guide can serve as a great resource to help you navigate these decisions. Plus, if you seek the support of a career counsellor or academic advisor, or even just want to talk with your parents about your career direction, this guide will help you get a lot more out of your conversations.
- **Have fun!** Spending time exploring your future is a really exciting time in your life. It can give you a great chance to learn amazing things about yourself, talk to wonderful people, and enjoy some really cool experiences. Enjoy!

My Personality



**Time
Commitment**

5 MINUTES

Your personality is essentially a collection of distinct qualities, traits, and characteristics that define you as an individual. When people create a career direction that aligns with their personality, they are more likely to feel that their work offers opportunities for them to 'be themselves'.

As you read through the following list, select words that you feel describe you well and capture the kind of person you are. If you have trouble with this section, ask for input from someone you trust who also knows you well.

My name is _____

I AM...

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Quiet | ☐ Independent | ☐ Energetic | ☐ Inspiring |
| ☐ Serious | ☐ Competent | ☐ Spontaneous | ☐ Negotiator |
| ☐ Dependable | ☐ High expectations | ☐ Active | ☐ Cooperative |
| ☐ Practical | ☐ Performer | ☐ Involved | ☐ Determined |
| ☐ Realistic | ☐ Dramatic | ☐ Outgoing | ☐ Empathetic |
| ☐ Responsible | ☐ Adventurous | ☐ Fun | ☐ Sociable |
| ☐ Logical | ☐ Tolerant | ☐ Imaginative | ☐ Knowledgeable |
| ☐ Orderly | ☐ Flexible | ☐ Appreciative | ☐ Risk-taker |
| ☐ Organized | ☐ Observer | ☐ Supportive | ☐ Confident |
| ☐ Friendly | ☐ Analyzer | ☐ Well-spoken | ☐ Innovative |
| ☐ Conscientious | ☐ Efficient | ☐ Outspoken | ☐ People-oriented |
| ☐ Committed | ☐ Kind | ☐ Resourceful | ☐ Persevere |
| ☐ Thorough | ☐ Respectful | ☐ Strategic | ☐ Assertive |
| ☐ Accurate | ☐ Idealistic | ☐ Systematic | |
| ☐ Loyal | ☐ Moral | ☐ Forceful | |
| ☐ Considerate | ☐ Curious | ☐ Warm | |
| ☐ Sensitive | ☐ Seek harmony | | |
| ☐ Thoughtful | ☐ Open-minded | | |
| ☐ Visionary | ☐ Understanding | | |
| ☐ Insightful | ☐ Accepting | | |
| ☐ Decisive | ☐ Theoretical | | |
| ☐ Motivator | ☐ Abstract | | |
| ☐ Original | ☐ Adaptable | | |
| ☐ Driven | ☐ Focused | | |
| ☐ Goal-oriented | ☐ Problem-solver | | |
| ☐ Theoretical | ☐ Critical | | |
| ☐ Skeptical | ☐ Conceptual | | |



Looking for more?

Take the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI®). The MBTI® can help you better understand your personality as well as the types of jobs, roles, and work environments that may be a good fit for you. Learn more about the **MBTI®**.

My Personality is adapted from Amundson, Poehnell, and Pattern (2005)

My Interests



**Time
Commitment**

Your interests are the activities, tasks, and topics that are a source of enjoyment and fulfillment for you. They are often the things that you enjoy in your spare time, like to be involved in, or find difficult to pull yourself away from! Your career does not need to include all your interests - many people who love music, for example, never become professional musicians. People

who create a career based on at least one area or activity of interest, however, are generally happier and more fulfilled in their work.

As you read through the following list, select words that you feel describe what you are interested in. Remember, we are not evaluating your skill in these areas, just whether or not you would enjoy them.

10 MINUTES

I am interested in...

Doing

- ☐ Producing tangible results
- ☐ Fixing, constructing, or building
- ☐ Using tools
- ☐ Being outdoors
- ☐ Making things work
- ☐ Action-oriented
- ☐ Working with my hands
- ☐ Hunting, camping, hiking
- ☐ Solving concrete problems
- ☐ Repairing, refinishing
- ☐ Physically demanding activities
- ☐ Operating equipment or machinery
- ☐ Operating recreational vehicles

Analyzing

- ☐ Solving abstract or intellectual problems
- ☐ Analyzing information
- ☐ Conducting research
- ☐ Learning new facts, ideas, theories
- ☐ Collecting and organizing data
- ☐ Complex and detailed activities
- ☐ Figuring out how things work
- ☐ Academic achievement
- ☐ Developing knowledge
- ☐ Designing processes
- ☐ Exploring theories
- ☐ Working in a lab or scientific setting
- ☐ Investigating and exploring

Creating

- ☐ Composing music
- ☐ Acting, performing
- ☐ Decorating
- ☐ Playing musical instruments
- ☐ Designing
- ☐ Going to museums or galleries
- ☐ Attending the theatre or concerts
- ☐ Writing poetry, plays or stories
- ☐ Reading
- ☐ Collecting art
- ☐ Dancing or yoga
- ☐ Drawing, sketching, or painting
- ☐ Taking photographs
- ☐ Cooking and entertaining
- ☐ Self-expression and imagination

Helping

- ☐ Working in groups
- ☐ Supporting people
- ☐ Building relationships
- ☐ Communicating with people
- ☐ Listening to others needs or problems
- ☐ Sharing responsibilities
- ☐ Collaborating with others
- ☐ Encouraging
- ☐ Empowering
- ☐ Helping, nurturing, or caring for others
- ☐ Training, instructing, or coaching
- ☐ Teaching or explaining
- ☐ Organizing social events
- ☐ Leading discussions
- ☐ Volunteering or community service
- ☐ Entertaining others
- ☐ Interacting with others

Leading

- ☐ Speaking in public
- ☐ Fund-raising
- ☐ Debating ideas
- ☐ Persuading or convincing
- ☐ Chairing committees, groups, organizations
- ☐ Competing against others
- ☐ Managing people and projects
- ☐ Taking risks and being adventurous
- ☐ Asserting ideas
- ☐ Marketing ideas, products or services
- ☐ Entrepreneurial ventures
- ☐ Negotiating contracts
- ☐ Earning money and acquiring wealth
- ☐ Building power, influence, status
- ☐ Following politics
- ☐ Investing in or following the stock market

Organizing

- ☐ Using or creating databases, spreadsheets
- ☐ Preparing and reading statements
- ☐ Keeping records and files
- ☐ Making charts and graphs
- ☐ Writing reports
- ☐ Activities that require accuracy and attention to detail
- ☐ Using computer software
- ☐ Conducting financial analysis
- ☐ Collecting and organizing information
- ☐ Creating and using efficient methods and strategies
- ☐ Organizing office procedures
- ☐ Performing calculations
- ☐ Following clear rules



Looking for more?

Take the Strong Interest Inventory (SII®). The SII® is a great resource to help you begin to clarify your interests, and identify your career and life goals. Learn more about the SII®.

My Values

Values are the things you believe in and feel are important to you. They guide your behavior and can heavily influence the choices you make in how you live your life. When your values are in conflict with your career, you may end up feeling frustrated or uncomfortable, and lose interest in your work. Your career will not necessarily align with all of your values, but identifying options that are a good fit with the things that are most important to you is important for developing a satisfying career. Read through the following list and rank how important each is to you using the following scale:

Very Important = You could not go without this and you would definitely not want to give it up!

Important = You would like this; It would be good/nice to have

Neutral = Undecided; You feel no strong emotion towards this one way or the other

Not Important = This is something you could easily go without or may in fact choose to avoid



**Time
Commitment**

I value...

10 MINUTES

	Not Important	Neutral	Important	Very Important
Security – feeling confident that you can get a job				
Variety – frequent changes in your work tasks				
Independence – working with little or no supervision				
Competition – opportunity to test your skills or match your performance against others				
Recognition – acknowledgement and appreciation				
Freedom – to manage your own schedule/workload				
Status – a position that is admired, respected, prestigious				
Money – significant financial benefit, make a lot of money				
Creativity – be expressive, imaginative, and original				
Decision-making – able to decide how things are done				
Contact – regular contact with colleagues, customers, clients, students, patients, etc.				
Help society – benefit society as a whole, greater good				
Help others – help individuals or groups				
Excitement – thrilling, lots of activity and action				
Belonging – feel that you are a part of a group/team				

	Not Important	Neutral	Important	Very Important
Work alone – do things on your own, not a lot of involvement with others				
Leadership – able to direct and influence others				
Expertise – be known as someone with special knowledge, skill and ability in a specific area				
Stability – steady and predictable work opportunities				
Relationships – have personal and/or professional relationships with people				
Balance – allows you to pursue interest and fulfill commitments outside of work				
Fun – find pleasure and enjoyment in your work				
Beauty – appreciate art, nature, and design; aesthetics				
Technology – use computers, electronic equipment, and technical software				
Structure – clear hierarchy, expectations and work arrangements				
Affiliation – be a part of a recognized group, organization or association				
Individuality – be unique, follow your own preferences				
Learn – gain new knowledge and acquire new skills				
Spiritual – fulfilling, feels good for your soul				
Serenity – calm, not lot of pressure or stress				
Kinesthetic – use your hands and body				
Problem-solving – opportunity to solve problems and develop solutions				
Location – allows you to work and/or live where you want (e.g. urban, rural, overseas)				
Physical challenge – requires strength, speed, or agility				

Looking for more?

The **CHOICES® Planner Work Values Sorter®** is designed to help you clarify your values and decide what is important to you in your work. Based on how you rank 20 value statements, the instrument will provide you with scores on six core work values and give you a list of occupations that match the core work values you scored highest on. Learn more about **CHOICES® Planner**.

Choices
PLANNER

My Values is adapted from Government of Alberta (1999) and Amundson et al. (2005)

My Skills



**Time
Commitment**

Your skills are the things that you do well. As skills often evolve from interests (people usually don't take the time to develop skills in things they are not interested in), understanding your skills will likely give you an indication of the types of careers that may be a natural fit for you. Remember, skills are acquired not only in the paid workplace; you can also develop them at school (collecting, writing, analyzing), while volunteering (supporting, guiding, organizing), in your spare time (collecting,

growing, designing), and in your day-to-day interaction with the people around you (listening, delegating, initiating).

As you read through the following list, select words that describe what you are good at and naturally tend to do well.

The goal of this activity is to help you better understand where your strengths, gifts, and talents lie.

10 MINUTES

My skills are in the areas of...

Leading

- ☐ Advising
- ☐ Appointing
- ☐ Assigning
- ☐ Authorizing
- ☐ Chairing
- ☐ Conducting
- ☐ Controlling
- ☐ Coordinating
- ☐ Deciding
- ☐ Delegating
- ☐ Designating
- ☐ Directing
- ☐ Enforcing
- ☐ Establishing
- ☐ Facilitating
- ☐ Governing
- ☐ Initiating
- ☐ Overseeing
- ☐ Prioritizing
- ☐ Planning
- ☐ Recommending
- ☐ Restructuring
- ☐ Supervising
- ☐ Strategizing

Doing

- ☐ Adjusting
- ☐ Assembling
- ☐ Building
- ☐ Constructing
- ☐ Cultivating
- ☐ Cutting
- ☐ Drilling
- ☐ Driving
- ☐ Growing
- ☐ Installing
- ☐ Lifting
- ☐ Loading
- ☐ Measuring
- ☐ Moving
- ☐ Mixing
- ☐ Operating
- ☐ Repairing
- ☐ Replacing
- ☐ Sewing
- ☐ Sorting
- ☐ Spraying

Helping

- ☐ Advising
- ☐ Advocating
- ☐ Aiding
- ☐ Assisting
- ☐ Attending
- ☐ Caring
- ☐ Coaching
- ☐ Counseling
- ☐ Demonstrating
- ☐ Empathizing
- ☐ Encouraging
- ☐ Facilitating
- ☐ Guiding
- ☐ Helping
- ☐ Instructing
- ☐ Listening
- ☐ Mentoring
- ☐ Motivating
- ☐ Referring
- ☐ Saving
- ☐ Serving
- ☐ Supporting
- ☐ Teaching

Creating

- ☐ Acting
- ☐ Carving
- ☐ Cooking
- ☐ Composing
- ☐ Conceptualizing
- ☐ Creating
- ☐ Decorating
- ☐ Designing
- ☐ Drawing
- ☐ Entertaining
- ☐ Generating
- ☐ Imagining
- ☐ Improvising
- ☐ Inventing
- ☐ Performing
- ☐ Visualizing

Communicating

- ☐ Corresponding
- ☐ Drafting
- ☐ Explaining
- ☐ Editing
- ☐ Formulating
- ☐ Influencing
- ☐ Interpreting
- ☐ Motivating
- ☐ Negotiating
- ☐ Promoting
- ☐ Recruiting
- ☐ Speaking
- ☐ Translating
- ☐ Writing

Financial

- ☐ Administrating
- ☐ Allocating
- ☐ Analyzing
- ☐ Appraising
- ☐ Auditing
- ☐ Balancing
- ☐ Budgeting
- ☐ Calculating
- ☐ Estimating
- ☐ Evaluating
- ☐ Forecasting
- ☐ Inspecting
- ☐ Projecting
- ☐ Reconciling
- ☐ Reducing
- ☐ Tracking

Technical

- ☐ Calculating
- ☐ Computing
- ☐ Devising
- ☐ Engineering
- ☐ Examining
- ☐ Inspecting
- ☐ Navigating
- ☐ Operating
- ☐ Processing
- ☐ Programming
- ☐ Remodelling
- ☐ Solving
- ☐ Surveying
- ☐ Testing
- ☐ Troubleshooting
- ☐ Upgrading
- ☐ Fixing

Researching

- ☐ Analyzing
- ☐ Assessing
- ☐ Clarifying
- ☐ Collecting
- ☐ Compiling
- ☐ Developing
- ☐ Designing
- ☐ Diagnosing
- ☐ Evaluating
- ☐ Focusing
- ☐ Interpreting
- ☐ Investigating
- ☐ Organizing
- ☐ Planning
- ☐ Preparing
- ☐ Reviewing
- ☐ Summarizing
- ☐ Surveying
- ☐ Theorizing

Administrating

- ☐ Arranging
- ☐ Cataloguing
- ☐ Charting
- ☐ Classifying
- ☐ Coding
- ☐ Collating
- ☐ Compiling
- ☐ Documenting
- ☐ Filing
- ☐ Generating
- ☐ Monitoring
- ☐ Organizing
- ☐ Processing
- ☐ Recording
- ☐ Retrieving
- ☐ Sending
- ☐ Sorting
- ☐ Tabulating
- ☐ Updating



My Skills is adapted from Amundson and Poehnell (2005)

My Best

Your best is simply you at your highest quality. Your finest. Those moments where you shine. With this in mind, take some time to complete the following statements. Each explores the qualities and characteristics that exemplify you at your best. When writing your answers try to use as much detail as you can. Point form is just fine. This activity might be a little challenging; it's okay to take some time to reflect and ponder. If you get stuck, ask for ideas from someone who knows you well or simply come back to it later.



**Time
Commitment**

30 MINUTES

My Best

1. I am at my best when ...

2. I am naturally really good at...

3. The best things about me are...

4. I most enjoy...

5. The best time of my life was...

6. I do my best learning when...

7. My most fulfilling life experience was...

My Best is adapted from The Gallup Organization (2006)



Time
Commitment

My Career Blueprint

30 MINUTES

A Career Blueprint

gives you a chance to pull things together, and begin to look at the big picture for patterns coming through that can guide your direction. Just like a traditional blueprint can help you design and construct a house, a Career Blueprint

can help you design and create your career. As you completed each of the previous pages, your responses were captured here to give you a personalized summary of your personality, interests, values, skills, and strengths. And remember, this is a blueprint not a 'set in stone' map - you will likely adjust things quite a bit as you go along.

Career Blueprint for _____

I AM....

Career Blueprint for _____

I LIKE...

Doing

Helping

Analyzing

Organizing

Creating

Leading

IValue...

Career Blueprint for _____

I AM GOOD AT....

Leading

Financial

Doing

Technical

Helping

Researching

Creating

Administrating

Communicating

I SHINE WHEN.....

1. I am at my best when ...

2. I am naturally really good at...

3. The best things about me are...

4. I most enjoy...

5. The best time of my life was...

6. I do my best learning when...

7. My most fulfilling life experience was...